KRANENBURG POWER ADVISORS

# Slot Machine

Gas turbine reservations, a paper shortage, and who holds the risk

29 October 2026

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DECISION BRIEF

US Power and Utilities

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### KPA CALLS

Each call carries a likelihood from the KPA scale, the date it resolves, and the record that decides it. KPA will score every call in a public scorecard.

- **GE Vernova reports at least 130 gigawatts (GW) of gas equipment backlog and slot reservations at the end of 2026.** Likely (70%). Basis: GE expects at least 130 GW and "13 GW plus" of fourth-quarter agreements; at about 5 GW of shipments a quarter, that delivers the 8 GW of net growth needed. Resolves January 2027, on GE Vernova's fourth-quarter release.
- **At least half of Project Matador's 11.3 GW is canceled, postponed or moved past 2030 in the Energy Information Administration's (EIA) December 2027 inventory.** Likely (60%). Basis: 99% of the capacity that dropped off earlier EIA lists was merchant; only Matador's first 1 GW is being built, and the other 10.2 GW has no signed tenant. Resolves February 2028, on EIA's Form 860M for December 2027.
- **GE Vernova's slot reservations are below 58 GW at the end of 2027.** Likely (60%). Basis: third-quarter conversions (13 GW) outran new reservations (8 GW); about 10 GW of 2029–30 slots remained in April. Resolves January 2028, on GE Vernova's fourth-quarter 2027 release; void if GE stops reporting reservations separately.

### WHAT WOULD CHANGE THIS VIEW

- A quarter in which new reservations again exceed conversions by a wide margin.
- More than half of 2028 gas plans under construction in EIA's data by mid-2027.
- Fermi America signing tenants for most of Project Matador's power.

### INDEPENDENCE

KPA is self-funded and has no sponsors or clients. This brief was researched and drafted with AI assistance; every figure traces to a listed source, and KPA's own calculations are reproduced in code. GE Vernova and Siemens Energy, cited throughout, sell the turbines discussed. This is version 1.1. Corrections are dated and listed with each version, and published numbers are never changed silently.

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## KEY IMPLICATIONS

On 28 October, GE Vernova reported 122 gigawatts (GW) of gas turbines on firm order or reserved, up from 50 GW in March 2025. In times past, an order book of that size would have meant a wave of power plants: turbines ordered, permits filed, and steel rising within two or three years. Yet the field is lagging the factory. Planned US gas capacity has risen 3.5 times in two years, while the share under construction fell from 26% to 18%. KPA analysis of EIA's own lists shows why the gap matters. Gas listed a year ahead has almost always been built; of gas listed two years ahead, 39–62% was canceled or postponed. Most of today's 64 GW is two or more years out, and half of what EIA lists as not yet seeking approval would serve data center campuses. The question is no longer only whether turbines can be found, but who pays for the slots that outlive their plants.

- **For new gas plants, a second queue has formed at the factory.** GE's 122 GW is about six years of its output; At GE's planned output, the book equals production through about mid-2031, and GE has already sold slots for 2032. Siemens Energy holds a further 69 GW, against the 15–16 GW it said it could deliver in its 2026 fiscal year.
- **The shortage is real at the factory but partly paper in the field.** EIA lists 37.4 GW of 2027–30 gas as not yet seeking approval, yet KPA's plant-by-plant check finds 41% of it approved or under construction. Much of the rest is a few large data center campuses. One, Project Matador in Texas, is 11.3 GW, about 18% of all US gas planned for 2027–30.
- **Buyers carry risk from the first deposit.** Reservations take deposits of 20–25% that GE calls non-refundable, and data centers hold about a third of them. Converting a reservation into an order, as GE did for 13 GW in the third quarter, adds payments and penalties but not the first exposure. At 2025 costs, the combined-cycle plants now planned would cost at least $31 billion more than at 2023 costs.

—October 2026

## WHAT IS NEW IN THIS BRIEF

KPA searched for prior publication of each finding before release. These results were not found in that search; everything else is credited to its source.

- Of the 37.4 GW of 2027–30 gas EIA lists as not yet seeking approval, 41% is already approved or under construction, and 52% would serve a data center campus.
- Gas on EIA's list one year ahead has been 94–100% built; of gas listed two years ahead, 35–46% is operating and 39–62% was canceled or postponed.
- The share of planned US gas capacity under construction fell from 26% to 18% between EIA's September 2024 and September 2026 lists.
- GE signed 6.7 GW of gas contracts for each GW it shipped in the second quarter of 2026, and 2.2 GW in the third.
- At BloombergNEF's 2025 cost, the planned combined-cycle fleet would cost at least $31 billion more than at its 2023 cost.

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# Slot Machine: Gas turbine reservations, a paper shortage, and who holds the risk

Liam Kranenburg[1]

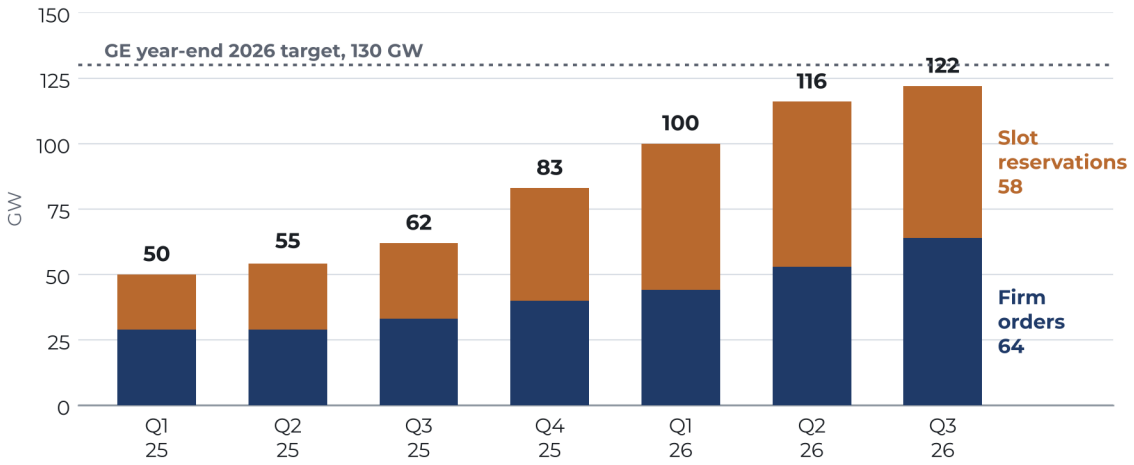
## A second queue has formed at the factory gate

For most of the past five years, the line that set the pace of the US power build was the interconnection queue, where projects wait, sometimes for years, for permission to connect. That line has not gone away. Yet for gas plants a second line now forms earlier, at the factory gate. On 28 October 2026, GE Vernova reported 122 GW of gas equipment in firm backlog or under slot reservation agreements, up from 50 GW at the end of March 2025 (see Figure 1). It expects at least 130 GW by the end of the year. The field tells a different story. The United States added 2.4 GW of gas nameplate capacity in 2024, the least in KPA's EIA-based series since 1998, and 5.3 GW in 2025.[2]

FIGURE 1

**GE Vernova's gas book more than doubled in 18 months, to 122 GW**

GE Vernova gas power equipment under contract at quarter end, gigawatts (GW): firm orders and slot reservations, March 2025 to September 2026




Source: KPA analysis of GE Vernova quarterly earnings releases. © KPA

A slot reservation is an option on factory time. The buyer pays to hold a delivery date and converts the reservation into a firm order once the plant behind it is ready to commit; GE has cited higher down payments on both as a source of cash. Of GE's 122 GW, 64 GW was firm orders and 58 GW was reservations at the end of September. In the third quarter, the company signed 11 GW of new contracts, 8 GW of them reservations. It converted 13 GW of reservations into orders and shipped 5 GW of equipment.[3]

1. *Kranenburg Power Advisors. Researched and drafted with AI assistance. All calculations in this brief use the public figures listed under Sources.*
2. *KPA analysis of EIA Form 860M (September 2026), counting units still operating or since retired by their first year of operation. Nameplate capacity runs above the summer capacity EIA uses in its own reports: EIA counts 4.6 GW of net summer gas capacity added in 2025.*

Measured against the factory, the book is long. GE said in July that it was on track for an annual output of 20 GW by the third quarter of 2026, and in October it cited a 5 GW quarterly run rate; it plans 24 GW in 2028 and 30 GW in 2030. At 20 GW a year, 122 GW is about six years of production, a ratio XenoSpectrum reported at 116 GW on 20 October.[4] At GE's planned output, the current book equals production through about mid-2031, and the 130 GW target through about the third quarter of 2031.[5] In July, GE said it expected to be more than half contracted for 2031 deliveries by the end of this year. Siemens Energy, one of the three large makers with GE and Mitsubishi Power, held a 69 GW backlog in June and said in August it could deliver 15–16 GW in its 2026 fiscal year, which ended in September.

The factory line is global, and so is its pressure. GE's gas contracts span about 100 customers in 25 countries, and its first-quarter 2026 signings came from the United States, Vietnam, Mexico, Brazil, and Canada. Siemens Energy's chief executive has said the addressable market could reach 120 GW a year, about half of it in the United States. US plants therefore compete for slots at prices set by the whole order book. On 28 October, GE said its full-year 2026 gas orders would be priced about 50% higher per kilowatt than its 2025 orders. Third-quarter orders were priced more than 20% above those of late 2025, helped by a larger share of smaller aeroderivative units.

The factory is not the only constraint, and GE argues it is not the binding one. Its chief executive, Scott Strazik, said in April that turbines are "not the gating item" in a three-year project cycle, and that directional lead times for new heavy-duty orders are about three years. That holds for a buyer who signs today only if earlier slots remain. The order book suggests few do: on 28 October, GE said it had sold several slots for delivery in 2032. EPRI put the wait for the largest units at more than five years in March. The two views can both be true. A short factory cycle and a long queue for the factory are different things. One measures the machine. The other measures the line in front of it.

## The turbine shortage is real at the factory but partly paper

If the factory's order book were a guide to the plants being built, the United States would be in a construction wave. It is not. KPA analysis of the federal monthly generator inventory, Form EIA-860M, shows planned US gas capacity rising from 20.6 GW in September 2024 to 40.5 GW in September 2025 and 71.1 GW in September 2026, an increase of 3.5 times in two years. Capacity under construction rose only from 5.4 GW to 13.1 GW. The share of planned gas capacity that is under construction fell from 26% to 18% (see Figure 2).[6]

3. *GE Vernova quarterly results, first quarter 2025 to third quarter 2026, as filed with the US Securities and Exchange Commission. "Equipment" covers heavy-duty and aeroderivative gas turbines. GE did not report first-quarter 2025 shipments.*
4. *Both the book and the output figure appear to cover heavy-duty and aeroderivative units, so the ratio compares like with like. It is an average: buyers of the largest heavy-duty units wait longer than buyers of aeroderivatives.*
5. *KPA calculation; GE's 2027 and 2029 output levels are interpolated between its stated 2026, 2028 and 2030 figures. Deliveries are scheduled by slot, so this is a measure of size, not a delivery date.*
6. *KPA counts EIA status codes U, V and TS as under construction. Capacity is nameplate. EDF and Atlas Public Policy reported a similar rise on 13 October 2026: 68 GW of fossil capacity planned for 2026–30, up 45% in six months.*

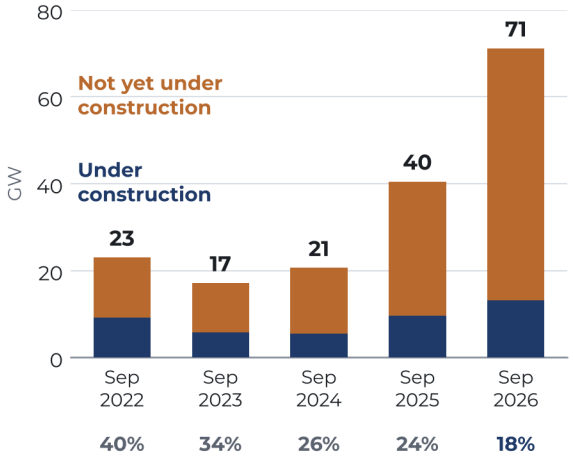
The pipeline looks thin at the front and thick at the back. Of the 64 GW planned to start operating in 2027–30, EIA lists 15% as under construction and 58% as planned with regulatory approvals not yet initiated, the earliest stage it records. Of the full 71 GW list, Texas accounts for 20.7 GW and Louisiana for 9.5 GW; combined-cycle plants make up 47 GW and simple-cycle combustion turbines 23 GW.

EIA's codes, though, lag the field. KPA checked each of the 35 plants behind the 37.4 GW that EIA lists for 2027–30 as not yet seeking approval, against regulators' orders, utility filings and company statements. Of that capacity, 15.4 GW, or 41%, is already approved or under construction. It includes TVA's Kingston plant in Tennessee, Georgia Power's new units at Plant Yates, and the 4.4 GW Homer City campus in Pennsylvania, where seven GE turbines are on order. Another 5.8 GW is before regulators (see Figure 3).[7]

FIGURE 2

**Planned US gas capacity tripled in four years; construction did not keep pace**

Planned US natural gas capacity in each September inventory, GW; share under construction below each bar

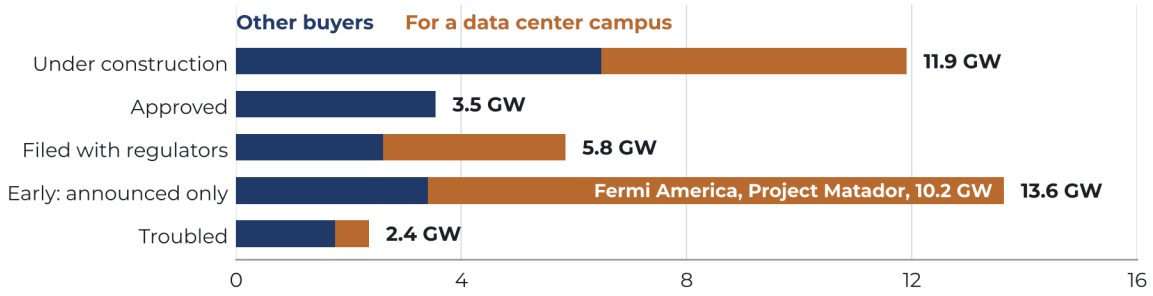



Source: KPA analysis of EIA Form 860M data. © KPA

FIGURE 3

**Of the gas EIA lists as not seeking approval, 41% is approved or building**

Status found by KPA, October 2026, of 2027–30 US gas that EIA codes as not yet seeking approval, GW




Source: KPA plant-by-plant check of EIA Form 860M, September 2026. © KPA

What remains is concentrated. Of the 37.4 GW, 19.5 GW, or 52%, would serve a named data center campus. One project, Fermi America's Project Matador near Amarillo, Texas, accounts for 11.3 GW, about 18% of all US gas planned for 2027–30. Only its first phases, about 1 GW, are under construction, and they carry Fermi's one signed tenant,

7. *KPA review of state commission dockets, utility and company releases, SEC filings and trade press, October 2026; one source per plant in the brief's data file. Capacity is EIA's nameplate figure for 2027–30. Status codes are reported to EIA by plant owners and can trail events by months. Texas merchant plants need no state certificate; KPA counts Sandow Lakes, financed and under a construction contract, as approved. Without it, the share is 38%.*

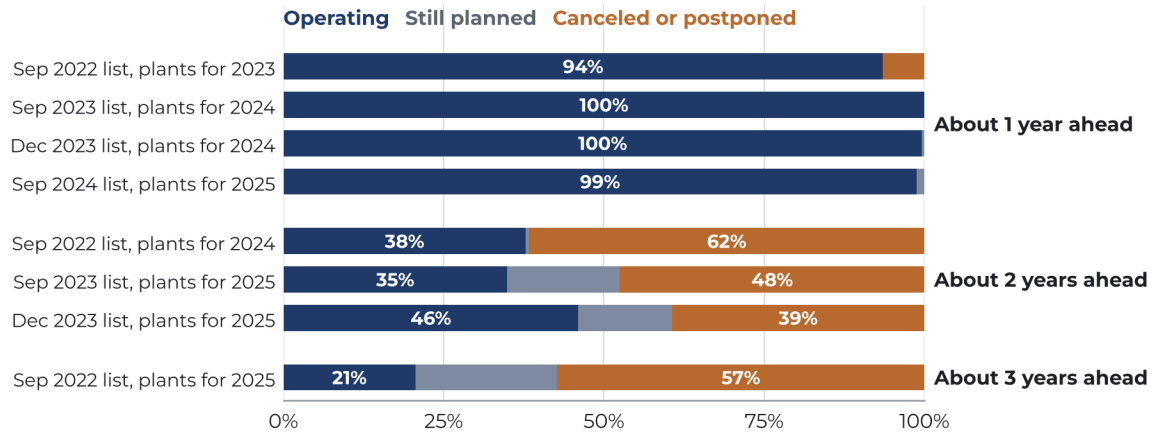
a lease for 222 megawatts (MW). The other 10.2 GW has no signed buyer, and Fermi reset its timeline in March. The paper in the US gas pipeline is less a broad weakness than a handful of giant projects.[8]

The record shows how much the calendar matters. KPA traced every gas generator on four earlier EIA lists to its status in September 2026, counting only plants whose planned year has passed. Plants listed about a year ahead were almost all built: 94–100% of the capacity is operating. Plants listed about two years ahead were not. Of that capacity, 35–46% is operating and 39–62% was canceled or indefinitely postponed, in EIA's terms. Of the gas listed in September 2022 for 2025, three years ahead, 21% is running (see Figure 4). Almost all of the capacity that dropped off, 99%, belonged to independent producers, among them Renovo in Pennsylvania, Gila Bend in Arizona and Killingly in Connecticut.[9]

FIGURE 4

**Gas listed a year ahead gets built; two years ahead, most of it has not**

Status in September 2026 of US gas capacity listed as planned in earlier EIA inventories, by planned year, share of nameplate capacity




Source: KPA analysis of EIA Form 860M data. © KPA

Today's list sits mostly at the far end of that record. Only the 10.7 GW planned for 2027 is about a year out, and on EIA's codes even that group is less advanced than any earlier year-ahead group: 46% under construction, against 59–86% before. The plant-by-plant check suggests much of that gap is stale coding. The record is also small, four groups and 22 GW, and almost entirely merchant, so it is a yardstick rather than a forecast. Applied to the 25 GW of 2028–30 plans held by independent producers, it would put 10–16 GW at risk, and 10.4 GW of those plans are Project Matador.

8. *Global Energy Monitor has tracked the rise of gas proposals tied to data centers, which nearly doubled in the first half of 2026. Fermi America, second-quarter 2026 results, 13 August 2026; Converge Digest, 30 March 2026.*
9. *Related completion rates have been published by Cleanview (2025), LBNL (Queued Up, 2026) and munimv2 (October 2026). Postponed plants can return to the list.*

Nor is the US build large by historical standards. In 2000–03 the United States added 196 GW of nameplate gas capacity, 49 GW a year, with 68.6 GW in 2002 alone, by KPA's count of EIA records.[10] Planned additions for 2028–30 average about 18 GW a year. That is twice the 9.2 GW a year of 2015–24, but little more than a third of the 2000–03 pace, a gap CoBank also drew in July.

The turbine shortage, then, is not the product of a US build larger than the last boom. It reflects a global order book meeting factory capacity that is only now being expanded. GE has installed more than 280 new manufacturing machines in its gas turbine factories since early 2025. A slot sold for 2031 is spoken for: if its holder walks away, GE keeps the deposit and can sell the slot again, often at a higher price.

The counter-argument is that the paper will turn to steel faster than before. GE describes about 80% of its gas book as traditional customers: utilities, independent power producers and industrial companies. Utilities hold 57% of the US gas planned for 2027–30, and the plant-by-plant check supports the optimists: of the utility capacity EIA codes as not yet seeking approval, 83% has at least been filed with regulators. Yet a deposit on a 2030 slot is not a permit, a pipeline connection, or an interconnection agreement, and the largest single block of planned capacity is a data center campus with no signed buyer for most of its power.

## Buyers carry risk from the first deposit

In the third quarter of 2026, the mix of the order book shifted. GE converted 13 GW of reservations into firm orders, the most in any quarter since at least mid-2025, and signed 8 GW of new reservations. Reservations therefore fell, from 63 GW to 58 GW: the first fall since at least early 2025. New contracts of 11 GW were the fewest in five quarters. In money terms the quarter was large. GE booked $21.8 billion of Power orders, up 178% on an organic basis, including 55 heavy-duty gas turbines, 21 of them its largest HA class, and 57 aeroderivative units.

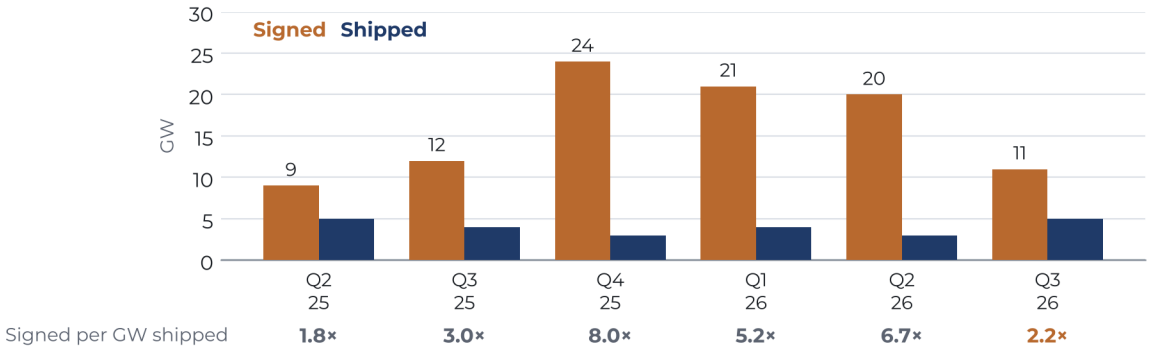
KPA analysis of GE's quarterly figures shows the gap between signing and shipping narrowing. In the second quarter, GE signed 6.7 GW of new gas contracts for each gigawatt it shipped; in the third, 2.2, partly because shipments rose from 3 GW to 5 GW (see Figure 5). Over the past four quarters the ratio was about five to one. A falling ratio can mean two different things: buyers are running out of near-term slots to reserve, or the rush to reserve is cooling. An analyst at BNP Paribas said in July that GE's caution about 2032 bookings could signal "peak momentum emerging." Three months later, GE reported selling 2032 slots, said it saw no slowing in conversions, and guided to 13 GW or more of new agreements in the fourth quarter. The data do not yet separate the two.

10. *Units still operating or retired since, as listed in EIA-860M for September 2026, each counted once. Units retired before EIA's list begins are missing, so the total is a lower bound; on a summer-capacity basis the figures are lower. CoBank, whose July report calls today's build a "dash to gas," puts the 2002 peak at 61 GW.*

FIGURE 5

**Signings fell toward shipments in the third quarter**

GE Vernova gas equipment contracts signed and equipment shipped, by quarter, GW, with GW signed per GW shipped below each quarter




Source: KPA analysis of GE Vernova quarterly earnings releases. © KPA

Either way, the buyer already carries the risk. GE does not file the terms of its reservations, but its executives have described them on earnings calls and at an investor conference. Customers have often put down 20–25% of the turbine contract, and the company's chief financial officer said in October 2025 that the deposits are non-refundable for reservations and firm orders alike. A reservation holder may walk away, as GE's annual report warns, but it walks away without the deposit. The chief executive has called the order label "more our classification than the customers." Conversion adds milestone payments and penalties; it does not create the exposure. GE, for its part, reports that no customer has asked to exit.[11]

The exposure is not spread evenly. Data centers account for about 20% of GE's gas book but about a third of its reservations, by GE's account in March, the least committed layer of the order book. For a regulated utility, a deposit is often the first large cost of a plant whose recovery from customers will be argued later, in a rate case. For a data center developer or an independent producer, it is a bet that the campus or the capacity price arrives on time.

The price of the commitment has also risen. BloombergNEF puts the average capital cost of a US combined-cycle plant at $2,157 per kilowatt (kW) in 2025, up from under $1,500 in 2023. KPA applied that increase to the 47 GW of combined-cycle capacity in EIA's planned list. Built at 2025 costs, those plants would cost at least $31 billion more than at 2023 costs. That is slightly more than major US utilities spent on transmission in all of 2023, though the premium would be paid over several years of construction.[12] BNP Paribas put HA-class combined-cycle turbines at about $950/kW in July.

The last time turbines were this scarce, the risk sat elsewhere. In 2001, merchant developers planned 380 GW of new capacity on a base of 750 GW. Within about six months of the market's turn in late 2001, almost a quarter of the planned turbine capa-

11. *GE Vernova earnings calls of 23 April 2025, 22 October 2025 and 28 October 2026; Bank of America conference, 18 March 2026; 2025 Form 10-K risk factors. Reservations carry prices 10–20 points above the firm backlog, according to GE.*

city had been abandoned, and in July 2002 GE forecast that US gas turbine orders would fall by 80% or more over two years. Those were unregulated projects, financed by developers and lenders rather than by captive customers. Today, utilities hold most of the US gas planned for 2027–30, and a utility's approved costs are recovered from households and businesses.

None of this makes the new gas build a bubble. Demand for firm capacity is real, and a utility that waits may find no slot before 2031. Large-load tariffs and service rules, approved or proposed in 37 states by mid-2026, are designed to shift part of that risk to the large customers they serve. Many set minimum contract terms and minimum load guarantees. Still, the order book is committing buyers faster than the field is permitting plants. If the merchant plans for 2028–30 fare as merchant plants listed two or more years ahead have, 10–16 GW would drop off the list, and any factory slot reserved for them carries a deposit that GE says is non-refundable.

12. *KPA calculation: 47.1 GW × ($2,157 − $1,500) per kW = $31.0 billion. BloombergNEF put 2023 costs under $1,500/kW, so the figure is a lower bound on that basis; it assumes every planned plant is built at the 2025 average cost. EIA put real transmission spending by major US utilities at $27.7 billion in 2023.*

## Sources


1. GE Vernova, quarterly earnings releases, first quarter 2025 to third quarter 2026 (Form 8-K filings of 23 April 2025, 23 July 2025, 22 October 2025, 28 January 2026, 22 April 2026, 22 July 2026 and 28 October 2026); first-quarter 2025 earnings call, 23 April 2025 (down payments on reservations).
2. GE Vernova, third-quarter 2026 earnings call, 28 October 2026, transcript by *The Motley Fool* (2032 slots, order pricing, customer count and mix, conversions, fourth-quarter guidance).
3. B. Martucci, "GE Vernova gas turbine backlog climbs to 116 GW," *Utility Dive*, 23 July 2026 (2031 and 2032 contracting, customer mix, BNP Paribas estimates and comments).
4. K. Clark, "Data centers drive record surge in GE Vernova power equipment orders as turbine slots tighten through 2030," *Power Engineering*, 23 April 2026 (customer mix, first-quarter signings, 2029–30 slots, lead times, factory additions, Strazik quotation).
5. E. Penrod, "Siemens gas turbine backlog nears 70 GW as company expands manufacturing," *Utility Dive*, 10 August 2026.
6. B. Noble (EPRI), op-ed in *Utility Dive*, 23 March 2026 (turbine lead times).
7. US Energy Information Administration (EIA), Form EIA-860M, *Preliminary Monthly Electric Generator Inventory*, September 2022, September 2023, December 2023, September 2024, September 2025 and September 2026 editions.
8. BloombergNEF, reported by *Bloomberg*, 23 April 2026 (US combined-cycle capital cost).
9. EIA, "Grid infrastructure investments drive increase in utility spending over last two decades," *Today in Energy*, 18 November 2024 (transmission spending by major utilities, 2023, real 2023 dollars).
10. R. Sansom and A. M. Schaal, "Gas Turbinemania: The Merchant Power Plant Shake Out," *Public Utilities Fortnightly*, 15 June 2002; GE Power Systems, press release, 23 July 2002 (forecast decline in US gas turbine orders).
11. GE Vernova reservation terms: earnings calls of 23 April 2025, 22 October 2025 and 28 October 2026; Bank of America Global Industrials Conference, 18 March 2026; 2025 Form 10-K, risk factors. EIA, *Electric Power Annual*, Table 4.6 (2025 net summer capacity additions).
12. NC Clean Energy Technology Center and Smart Electric Power Alliance, Database of Emerging Large-Load Tariffs (DELTa), second-quarter 2026 update, reported 1 September 2026 (37 states with approved or proposed tariffs or service rules); M. Lutz, "Large load tariffs proliferate as states take more active role in data center regulation," *Utility Dive*, 31 March 2026 (common tariff terms).
13. Plant-by-plant status check (Figure 3): KPA review, October 2026, of state commission dockets, utility and company releases, SEC filings and trade press for the 35 plants EIA codes as not yet seeking approval for 2027–30, one source per plant in the brief's data file; Fermi America, second-quarter 2026 results, 13 August 2026; Converge Digest, 30 March 2026 (Matador timeline); Global Energy Monitor, August 2026 (gas proposals tied to data centers).
14. KPA calculations (Figures 1–5, the order-book and delivery ratios, the EIA-860M vintage, status, lead-time and cohort analysis, historical additions, and the cost premium) are reproducible from the data files published with this brief.
15. Prior work this brief builds on: Y. Kobayashi, XenoSpectrum, 20 October 2026 (GE backlog in years of output); EDF and Atlas Public Policy, 13 October 2026 (planned fossil capacity); munimv2, analysis of EIA-860M vintages, October 2026 (slippage of 2026 plans); D. DiGangi and M. Lutz, "What the last gas boom (and bust) says about today's rush to build," *Utility Dive*, 4 November 2025; T. Viswanath, "Dash to gas," CoBank, 28 July 2026 (planned gas against the 2000s build); Frontier, "Gas turbines: the plans, the slots," 23 September 2026 (growth of EIA's planned gas list); M. Thomas, Cleanview, 29 July 2025, and LBNL, *Queued Up*, 2026 edition (completion rates for proposed gas plants). munimv2's analysis is an AI-assisted, self-published post on dev.to and is credited here as prior work only.
16. KPA calls: GE Vernova releases, 22 July 2026 and 28 October 2026 (targets, conversions); *Utility Dive*, 23 July 2026 (2025 target and result); *Power Engineering*, 23 April 2026 (2029–30 slots); EIA Form 860M, September 2025 and September 2026 (status of planned gas).


**Changes in version 1.1 (29 October 2026).** Added KPA's plant-by-plant check of EIA status codes (Figure 3) and lead-time base rates (Figure 4), replacing a cohort figure that mixed plants already due with plants not yet due; the historical additions chart became text, credited to CoBank. Reframed the third section: GE describes reservation deposits as non-refundable, so buyers carry risk from the first deposit. Replaced the call that less than 70% of the 2027 group would be operating by the end of 2027 (85%), which rested on status codes the check shows to lag, and replaced v1.0's estimate that some 20 GW of 2027–30 plans would be canceled with a narrower range for merchant plans. Corrected GE's output statement, Siemens Energy's delivery figure, a source date and a turbine-cost description. Credited CoBank, Frontier, Cleanview, LBNL and Global Energy Monitor.

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